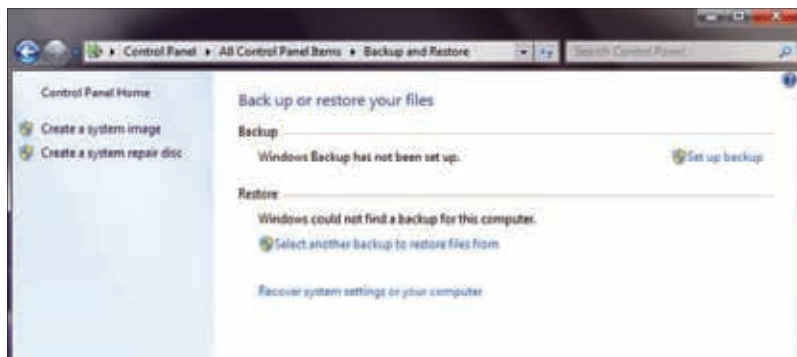


7 Backup and Restore



Backup and Restore window in Windows 7

7.1 Backup

The data stored on your computer's hard-disk is valuable and perhaps irreplaceable. If you have lost files on your computer and you are not familiar with data backup or you just chose not to backup because its too much trouble, this chapter is for you.

If you are one of those lucky people who have never lost a file on your computer: congratulations! However it is still vital for you to understand that encountering problems sometimes is inevitable. It can result from your fault while making a change or a virus or just some power surge leading to hardware failure. That's why you should regularly backup your files, preferably to an external hard-disk to be prepared for the worst. Windows 7 comes with its own Backup utility, that's designed to read your data, compress it and store it on the external medium automatically and you can even set a predefined schedule for it.

7.1.1 How is it different from Copy Pasting Data?

Backup and Restore feature has several advantages over simply copying files to a removable disk. This utility compresses your data as its being copied on the fly so that more of it fits into the medium. It even allows you to split large files across multiple disks and in emergency, it offers several data-recovery aids for you to recover files quickly. If you're using the Professional, Enterprise or Ultimate editions of Windows 7, you'll also have the option